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Olive oil

9.3 Olive oil

References:

Hebrew יִצְהָר (yitshar) NUM 18:12, DEU 7:13, DEU 11:14, DEU 12:17, DEU 14:23, DEU 18:4, DEU 28:51, 2KI 18:32, 2CH 31:5, 2CH 32:28, NEH 5:11, NEH 10:38, NEH 10:40, NEH 13:5, NEH 13:12, JER 31:12, HOS 2:10, HOS 2:24, JOL 1:10, JOL 2:19, JOL 2:24, HAG 1:11

Hebrew שֶׁמֶן (shemen) GEN 28:18, GEN 35:14, EXO 25:6, EXO 25:6, EXO 27:20, EXO 29:2, EXO 29:2, EXO 29:7, EXO 29:21, EXO 29:23, EXO 29:40, EXO 30:24, EXO 30:25, EXO 30:25, EXO 30:31, EXO 31:11, EXO 35:8, EXO 35:8, EXO 35:14, EXO 35:15, EXO 35:28, EXO 35:28, EXO 37:29, EXO 39:37, EXO 39:38, EXO 40:9, LEV 2:1, LEV 2:2, LEV 2:4, LEV 2:4, LEV 2:5, LEV 2:6, LEV 2:7, LEV 2:15, LEV 2:16, LEV 5:11, LEV 6:8, LEV 6:14, LEV 7:10, LEV 7:12, LEV 7:12, LEV 7:12, LEV 8:2, LEV 8:10, LEV 8:12, LEV 8:26, LEV 8:30, LEV 9:4, LEV 10:7, LEV 14:10, LEV 14:10, LEV 14:12, LEV 14:15, LEV 14:16, LEV 14:16, LEV 14:17, LEV 14:18, LEV 14:21, LEV 14:21, LEV 14:24, LEV 14:26, LEV 14:27, LEV 14:28, LEV 14:29, LEV 21:10, LEV 21:12, LEV 23:13, LEV 24:2, NUM 4:9, NUM 4:16, NUM 4:16, NUM 5:15, NUM 6:15, NUM 6:15, NUM 7:13, NUM 7:19, NUM 7:25, NUM 7:31, NUM 7:37, NUM 7:43, NUM 7:49, NUM 7:55, NUM 7:61, NUM 7:67, NUM 7:73, NUM 7:79, NUM 8:8, NUM 11:8, NUM 15:4, NUM 15:6, NUM 15:9, NUM 28:5, NUM 28:9, NUM 28:12, NUM 28:12, NUM 28:13, NUM 28:20, NUM 28:28, NUM 29:3, NUM 29:9, NUM 29:14, NUM 35:25, DEU 8:8, DEU 28:40, DEU 32:13, DEU 33:24, 1SA 10:1, 1SA 16:1, 1SA 16:13, 2SA 1:21, 2SA 14:2, 1KI 1:39, 1KI 5:25, 1KI 17:12, 1KI 17:14, 1KI 17:16, 2KI 4:2, 2KI 4:6, 2KI 4:7, 2KI 9:1, 2KI 9:3, 2KI 9:6, 2KI 20:13, 1CH 9:29, 1CH 12:41, 1CH 27:28, 2CH 2:9, 2CH 2:14, 2CH 11:11, EZR 3:7, EST 2:12, JOB 29:6, PSA 23:5, PSA 45:8, PSA 55:22, PSA 89:21, PSA 92:11, PSA 104:15, PSA 109:18, PSA 133:2, PSA 141:5, PRO 5:3, PRO 21:17, PRO 21:20, PRO 27:9, PRO 27:16, ECC 7:1, ECC 9:8, ECC 10:1, SNG 1:3, SNG 1:3, SNG 4:10, ISA 1:6, ISA 39:2, ISA 57:9, ISA 61:3, JER 40:10, JER 41:8, EZK 16:9, EZK 16:13, EZK 16:18, EZK 16:19, EZK 23:41, EZK 27:17, EZK 32:14, EZK 45:14, EZK 45:14, EZK 45:24, EZK 45:25, EZK 46:5, EZK 46:7, EZK 46:11, EZK 46:14, EZK 46:15, HOS 2:7, HOS 12:2, AMO 6:6, MIC 6:7, MIC 6:15, HAG 2:12

Greek ἔλαιον (elaion) MAT 25:4, MAT 25:4, MAT 25:8, MRK 6:13, LUK 7:46, LUK 10:34, LUK 16:6, HEB 1:9, JAS 5:14, REV 6:6, REV 18:13, JDT 10:5, JDT 11:13, ESG 2:12, SIR 39:26, SIR 45:15, BEL 1:3, 1ES 6:29, ODA 2:13

Description:

Olive oil is extracted from the fruit of the olive tree.

Usage:

The fruit of the olive tree was crushed in order to extract the oil it contained. The successive stages of the extraction produced oil of decreasing quality. Olive oil was used as food, as medicine (see 1.15.1 Oil, ointment<REALIA:1.15.1>), as fuel for burning in lamps (see 5.1 Oil lamp and wick<REALIA:5.1>), and as a perfume when mixed with sweet-smelling substances (see 10.6.1 Perfumes<REALIA:10.6.1>). It was also offered with some cereal offerings in the Tabernacle and Temple (see, for example, LEV 2:0). Oil was also spread on war shields (see 2.10.2 Small shield, buckler<REALIA:2.10.2>). It was also used to anoint certain objects or people as an act of consecration (see 1.10.5 Anointing oil<REALIA:1.10.5>). The composition of the priestly anointing oil is given in EXO 30:22–EXO 30:25.

Translation:

“Oil” in the Bible almost always refers to olive oil. Where olives and olive oil are unknown, it may be possible to substitute the oil extract of some other plant, such as soy or maize. A word referring to animal fat will not normally be appropriate. Many languages have a separate word for a refined petroleum product. Such a product was unknown in the ancient world, and the word for it should never be used.

The Hebrew word yitshar represents a higher quality of oil that was extracted with the first pressing. In all the passages listed above, the word probably refers to oil used for food.

The Hebrew word shemen refers to a food in 1KI 5:25; 1KI 17:12; 1KI 17:14; 1KI 17:16; 2KI 4:2; 2KI 4:6; 2KI 4:7; 1CH 12:41 and other places.

The Greek word elaion refers to a food in LUK 16:6; REV 6:6; REV 18:13; JDT 10:5; JDT 11:13; SIR 39:26; 1ES 6:29.